



Kyocera Mita India Pvt. Ltd launches range of MFPs

Dubbed as "Smart MFPs", these machines simplify regular office document processing and are easy to use. It has all standard features and there is no need to spend additionally on expensive options.

Photo Printer Test

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Single function printers are slowly being eclipsed by multi function devices. But photo-only printers still find use in many households and office environments, where the need to feel and experience a good old photo print still runs fresh.

In the following pages, we compare six photo printers from Canon, Epson and HP – getting MFDs was easy, but procuring photo printers from brands proved difficult. These printers are a mix of home and office printers, some have absolutely no added features apart from physical buttons and a USB connectivity cable, while others have duplex-printing, Wi-Fi support and Ethernet connectivity to boast. Some come with just two cartridges, while others have as many as six – one particular printer came with no cartridges at all, but something called an “ink tank system”. Not only do these printers print photographs, but they’re also useful for occasional document printing.

So without much ado, let’s take a look at the following photo printers:

HP Deskjet Ink Advantage K109a

The HP Deskjet Ink Advantage K109a is a port-

able inkjet printer that starts off our comparison test. The printer is nicely packed in a petite box, secured with styro-foam – if there’s one thing this comparison brought to light and emphasised beyond a shred of doubt, is the superior packaging of HP printers. Both the HP printers in this comparison were packed better than printers from the other two brands – just for readers who are concerned about damages incurred by products during transportation.

Moving along from the packaging, the HP Deskjet Ink Advantage K109a is really light and has a low physical footprint. It is ideal for use in office cubicles or business places cramped for space. The K109a has an attractive sprite across its top lid which sets it apart from the rest of the printers in this shootout which are mostly dull, black monoliths. The printer comes with two cartridges – one for color and one for black.

The Deskjet Ink Advantage K109a is easy to setup, drivers can be downloaded off HP’s support web site, in case you don’t feel like popping in the printer’s software disc. One thing is readily visible as you start printing photos off the HP Ink Advantage K109a, it’s tray is small and it can’t keep A4 prints from falling over. And if that wasn’t enough, the printer spits them out unashamedly, instead of gently dropping the papers down.



HP Deskjet Ink Advantage K109a
Price ₹4,699

HOW WE TESTED

All printers in this comparison were tested on the same rig. As this was a photo printer test, we tested the printers using three test photographs. Photo 1 had a section dedicated as a human portrait of two sisters. Photo 2 is another Adobe RGB sample photo with vivid colors and various shades of black to properly ascertain black levels in prints. Photo



3 is a photo we use for all our printer tests, which covers a wide gamut of objects, patterns, faces etc. We also included one mixed document print test to check all the printers, as you would also use the photo printer to print documents. We only used A4 sized paper for our tests – photos were printed on a standard single-side glossy paper, while mixed documents (comprising of text and photos) were printed on regular plain paper.



For comparative analysis, we identified 6-7 regions in each photograph and assigned a score on 10 to each region as compared to other printers. An average of this score was assigned as the overall print quality score in the log sheet. This was done so as to cover all aspects of the printout rather than be biased by one particular aspect of the printout.

Apart from printer performance, we also gave points to features offered. Those having extra connectivity options such as memory card support, Wi-Fi, and network had an edge over others. Ease of installation, build quality and printer setup was also evaluated for each printer.